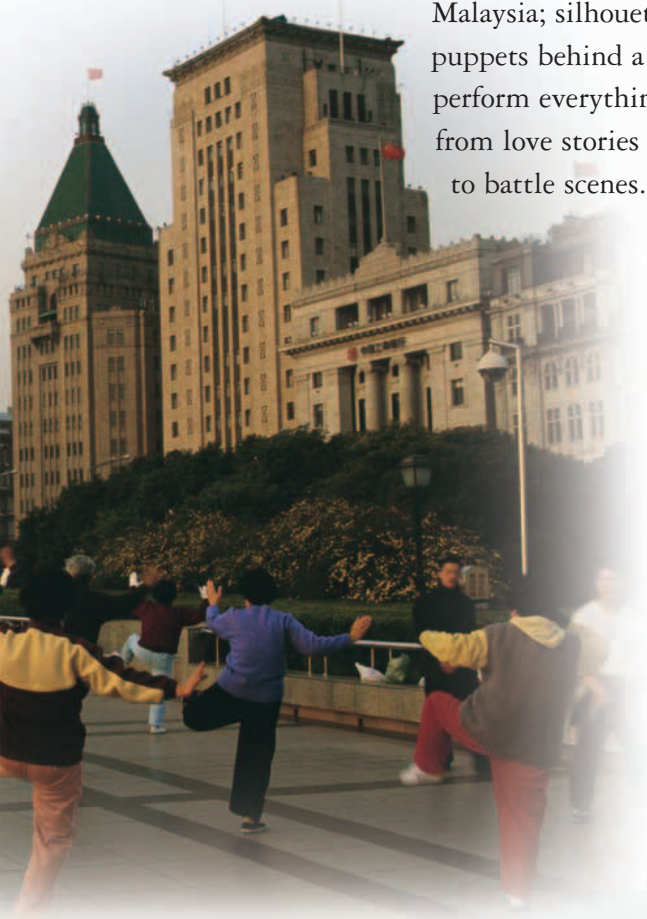




The arts

East and Southeast Asia have a rich tradition of performing arts, from music to drama and dance, or a combination of all three. Shadow puppets are a popular form of entertainment in Indonesia and Malaysia; silhouette puppets behind a sheet perform everything from love stories to battle scenes.



CRAFTS

The people of East Asia are renowned worldwide for their beautiful crafts. These include richly colored silks from Thailand and batik designs from Bali. The Chinese are skilled at kite making, jade carving, and papermaking, and products such as these beautiful parasols are popular all over the world.



RELIGION

Although Buddhism was founded in Nepal and India, it quickly spread across East Asia and has become one of the main religions in China, Japan, and Southeast Asia. Indonesia is predominantly Islamic with the exception of Bali, which is Hindu, and Philippines and Timor, which are Roman Catholic. The Asiatic part of Russia is also Christian. Other minority religions include Shinto in Japan and a Korean religion called Chondogyo.

HINDUISM ON BALI



The majority of Balinese practice a unique form of Hinduism called *Agama Tirtba*. It is predominantly Hindu, with Buddhist elements that were added to preexisting, religious customs.

Buddhist monks are allowed few possessions and spend much of their time meditating.

